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Week 9 Logic Lab

CIRCULAR REASONING AND BEGGING THE QUESTION

Purpose: Apply Week 9 skills to new examples. Do not copy examples from the reading handout.

Part 1: Spot the Circle

Question 1.1

“The new schedule is efficient because it is the most efficient schedule available.” Explain why this reason is circular.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

“We can trust the report because it comes from a trustworthy source.” What would independent support look like?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Loaded Definition

Question 2.1

“A serious student never questions the rubric. You questioned the rubric. Therefore you are not a serious student.” Where is the conclusion assumed?

Part 2 Q1

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Part 3: Rewrite

Question 3.1

Rewrite this argument so the reason does not assume the conclusion: “The election rule is fair because fair elections use this rule.” Keep a clear conclusion and give independent support or a narrowed claim.

Part 3 Q1

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Part 4: Argument in a Paragraph

Question 4.1

Read the paragraph. Identify the main conclusion, the circular reason, and one independent support that would be better.

At the budget hearing, a speaker said the stadium lights project must be approved because it is the project this community needs. Someone in the back asked about the cost of replacing the library roof. The speaker answered that real supporters of the school already know the lights are necessary, and only people who do not support the school keep asking for more proof. He sat down while the projector warmed up.

Part 4 Q1

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Part 5: Review

Question 5.1

“All bats sleep upside down in caves. The coach ordered new bats. Therefore the coach ordered new animals that sleep upside down in caves.” Identify the shifting term and both meanings.

Part 5 Q1

Question 5.2

“Anyone who questions the spirit-week schedule is against school pride. You questioned the schedule. Therefore you are against school pride.” Name the conclusion and the main defect.

Part 5 Q2